FlyingSalem

User Guide · iPhone and iPad



Destructive AI Gurus, LLC

Build 20261019.2 · Guide dated 2026-10-20

CONTENTS

1. **Part 1: At a glance.** What FlyingSalem is and what you can do with it.
2. **Part 2: The screen.** Every element of the flight screen, numbered.
3. **Part 3: Every control in detail.** Flying, speed, cameras, layers, the tour, pause, asking about a place, Go to, sound, and sources.

PART 1

At a glance

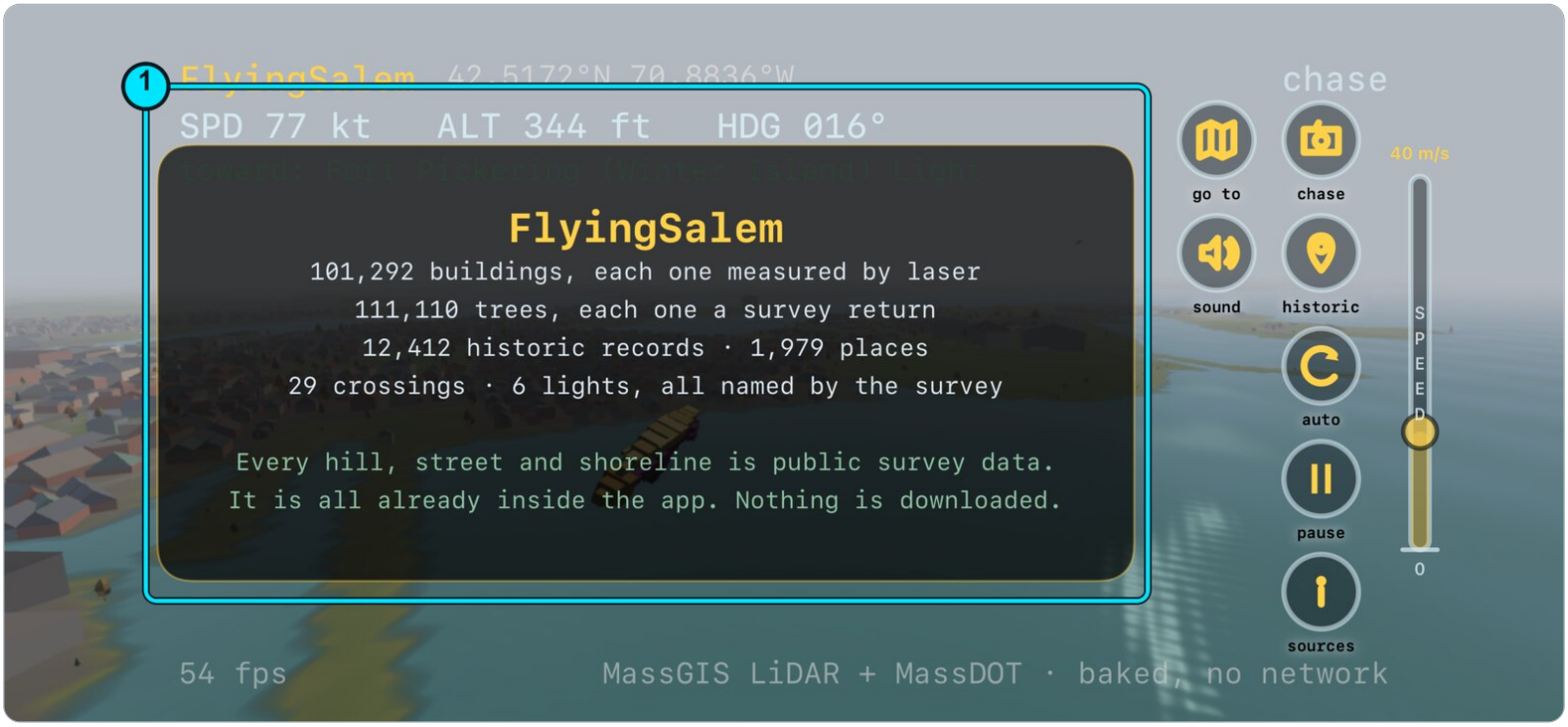
FlyingSalem lets you fly over the real city of Salem, Massachusetts. The town in the app is built from public survey data: the hills, streets and shoreline, more than a hundred thousand buildings each measured by laser, and thousands of historic records. As you fly, the places below you are named, and you can tap any of them to ask what it is.

What you can do

Feature	What it does
Take the tour	The app starts on **autopilot**: it flies you from landmark to landmark and tells you where it is heading. Take the controls whenever you like. The tour takes over again when you let go.
Fly it yourself	Put a finger anywhere on the screen and drag to steer. It works like an aeroplane's control stick: pull back to climb.
Choose your speed	The **S P E E D** slider goes from a full stop, hovering in place, up to 400 m/s.
See it from five cameras	Chase, wing, eye (the pilot's view), tower and map.
Choose what is named	Historic places only, everything (historic plus guide places), or marks without names.
Ask about a place	Tap a mark to see its name, address, historic designation or category, building height and distance.
Jump anywhere	**Go to** opens a map of Salem. Tap a spot and you fly there.
Pause and look around	Freeze the flight, then move, turn, tilt and change height to study a spot.
Hear the town	Places answer with sounds as you pass, such as lighthouses. No voices, and you can mute it.
See the sources	The **sources** button lists the public survey data the world is built from.

> **Everything is already inside the app.** FlyingSalem needs no internet connection and downloads nothing. Hold your iPhone or iPad sideways (landscape); the app runs in landscape only.

When the app opens

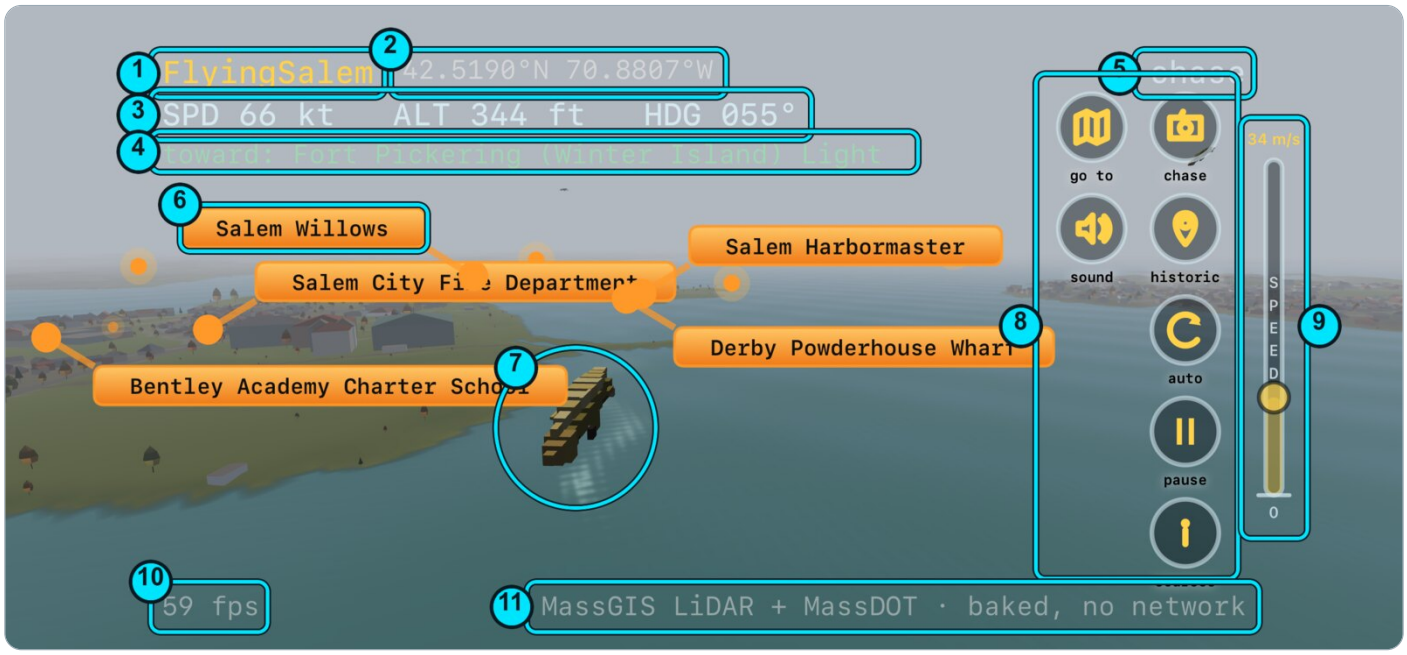


1 The opening card stays for about six seconds, then fades out as the place names fade in. Its numbers are counted from the data actually inside the app: buildings, trees, historic records, places, crossings and lights.

PART 2

The screen

This is the flight screen while the tour is flying. Each number is explained below. The controls on the right are covered one by one in Part 3.



The flight screen on the tour, chase camera, historic layer.

	Element	What it shows
1	Title	`FlyingSalem`
2	Position	Your latitude and longitude, updated as you fly.
3	Instruments	`SPD` airspeed in knots · `ALT` altitude in feet · `HDG` compass heading in degrees.
4	Tour line	Shown while the tour is on. `toward: …` names where the autopilot is heading. When you take over it reads `let go and the tour resumes`, or, if you have set a speed, `speed held · ↻ for the tour` (`stopped · ↻ for the tour` at a stop).
5	Camera name	Which camera you are looking through. When paused it reads `paused · chase` (or the current camera) in amber.
6	Place names	Orange name cards with a line to their mark. White dots are guide places (in the **all** layer). Tap any mark to ask about it.
7	Your craft	The aeroplane you are flying (seen from the chase, wing and tower cameras).
8	Buttons	Two columns of round buttons. Each one carries its current setting as a caption underneath.
9	S P E E D slider	Sets your speed. The number above it is the speed you have set; `0` at its foot is a full stop.
10	Frame rate	How smoothly the scene is drawing, in frames per second.
11	Credit	The survey data the world is built from: `MassGIS LiDAR + MassDOT · baked, no network`.

The buttons at a glance



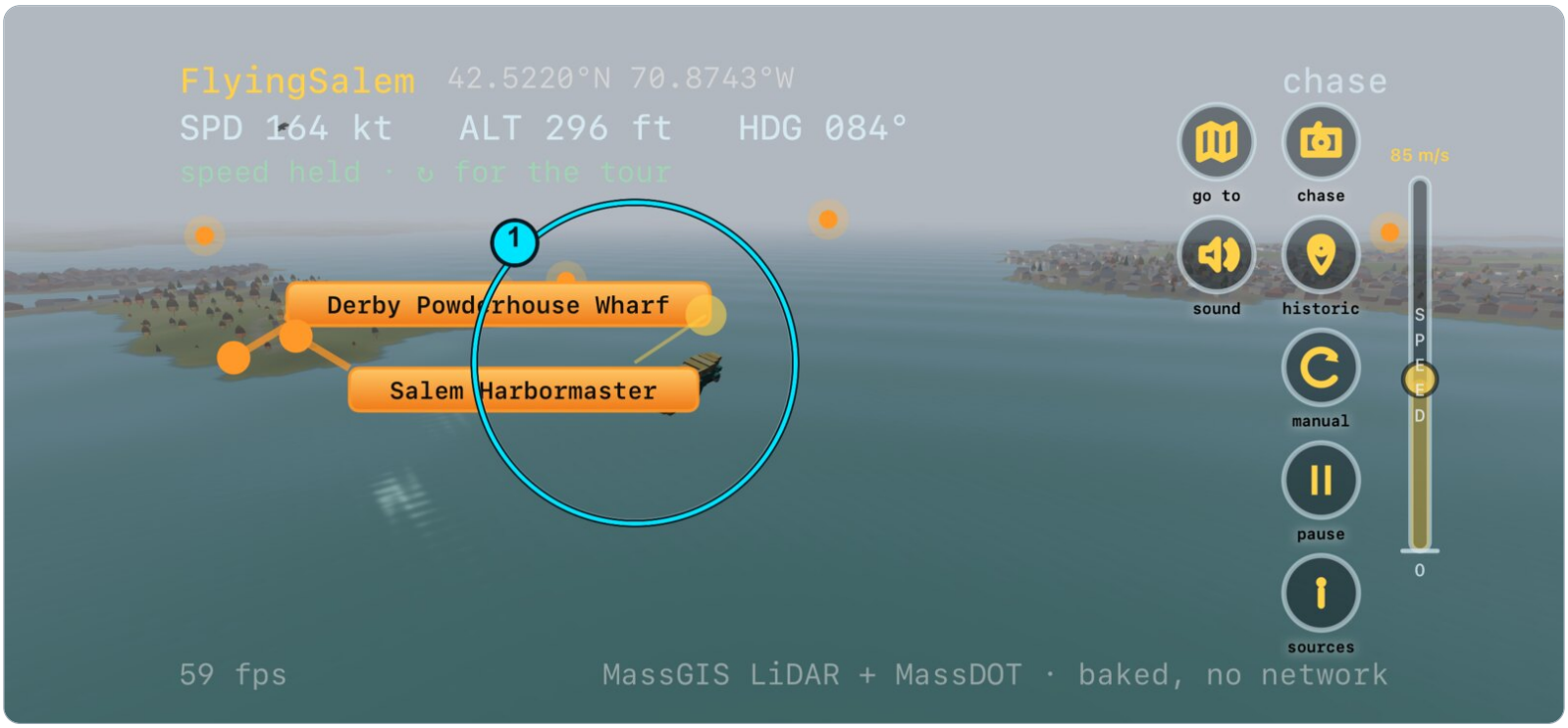
	Button	Caption shows	Tap it to…
1	Camera	`chase` · `wing` · `eye` · `tower` · `map`	Switch to the next camera.
2	Layer (map pin)	`historic` · `all` · `none`	Change which places are marked and named.
3	Tour (circular arrow)	`auto` · `manual`	Hand the aeroplane back to the tour.
4	Pause	`pause` · `resume`	Freeze the flight to look around, or carry on.
5	Sources (i)	`sources`	Open the list of data sources.
6	Go to (map)	`go to`	Open the map and fly to any spot.
7	Sound (speaker)	`sound` · `muted`	Turn the town's sounds on or off.
8	S P E E D slider	the speed you set, or `stop`	Drag up to go faster, down to slow and stop.

The icons change with the setting too: the pin is solid for **all**, an outline for **historic**, and struck through for **none**. The speaker shows sound waves when on and a cross when muted. The pause button shows ▶ when the flight is paused.

PART 3

Every control in detail

3.1 Flying: drag anywhere

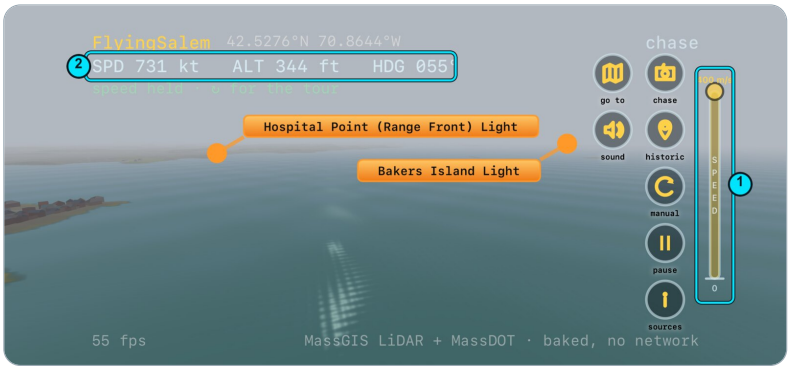


1 The control stick appears where your finger lands: a ring, with a line and knob that follow your finger.

- **Touch anywhere** that is not a button or the slider, and drag. You don't need to touch the aeroplane. The stick is centred wherever you put your finger.
- **Drag left or right** to bank and turn.
- **Drag down (pull back)** to climb, and **drag up (push forward)** to descend, as with a real control stick.
- **Let go** and the stick centres; the aeroplane levels out.
- A **quick tap** (a short touch that barely moves) is not flying: it asks about the place under your finger (see 3.7). Asking never takes you off the tour.

> On the tour, steering takes the controls. The tour line then reads `let go and the tour resumes` : stop touching for about 25 seconds and the autopilot takes over again.

3.2 Speed: the S P E E D slider



1 Slider at the top (400 m/s). 2 The instruments show the speed actually flown.



1 At `0` the readout says `stop`. 2 The tour line: `stopped · ↻ for the tour`. 3 The tour button reads `manual`.

- **Drag the slider up** to go faster, up to **400 m/s**. **Drag it down** to slow down. The number above the slider is the speed you have asked for, in metres per second.
- **At the bottom** (the line marked `0`) the aeroplane comes to a **stop and hovers**, and the readout says `stop`. It's a good way to park and look at something.
- The slider **stays where you leave it**; it does not spring back.
- The aeroplane speeds up and slows down smoothly, so the `SPD` instrument catches up with your setting after a moment.
- While the tour is flying, the slider shows the **tour's** speed. Touching it gives you the controls and your own speed.

> Once you have set a speed, the tour does **not** come back on its own, so you can park as long as you like. Tap the tour button ↻ when you want it back (see 3.5).

3.3 Cameras: the camera button

Tap the camera button to step through five views in this order. Its caption, and the camera name at the top right (2), show the current view.



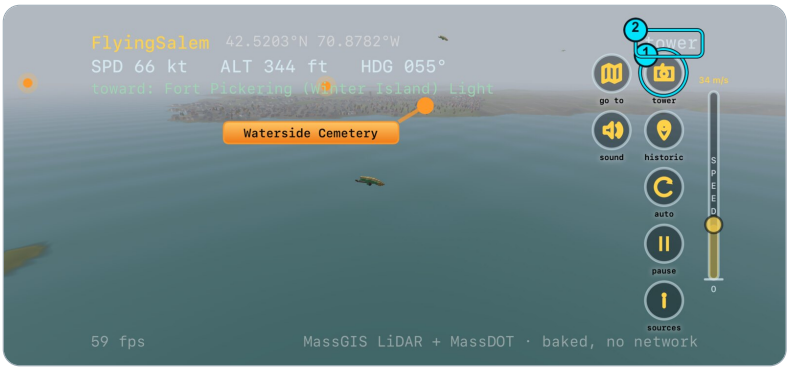
chase: behind and above the aeroplane. This is the starting view.



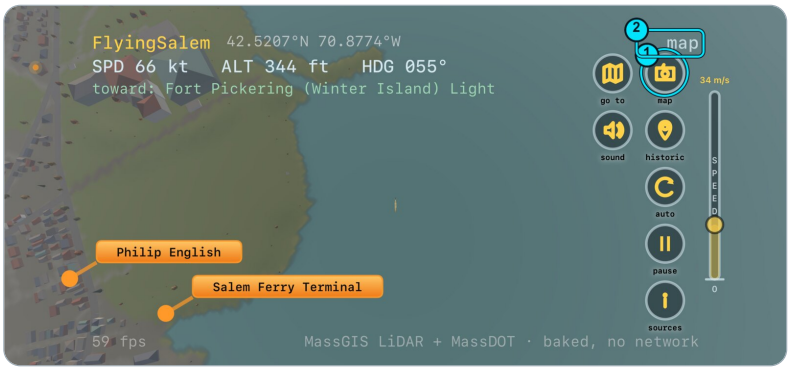
wing: off the left wingtip, slightly forward. The postcard angle.



eye: the pilot's view straight ahead. The horizon stays level as you turn.



tower: a slow orbit from well out, so the town is the subject.



map: looking straight down from above. Tap the camera button again to return to **chase**.

3.4 What is named: the layer button

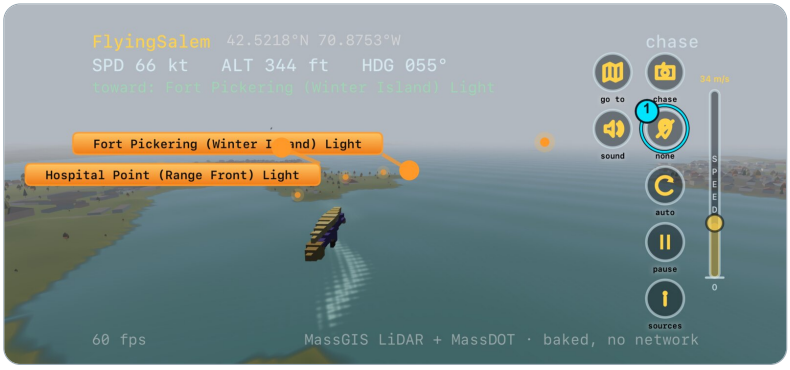
Tap the map-pin button to step through three layers: **historic → all → none**, then back to historic.



historic (outline pin): historic places from the Massachusetts historic inventory, marked in orange and named. This is the starting layer.



all (solid pin): historic places *plus* the guide's places (white marks), named when you are close.



none (pin struck through): places stay marked without names. Only the landmark beacons, such as lighthouses, keep their names.

> When places crowd together, historic names are given room first. Names go to places the camera can actually see, and a card that cannot fit above its mark tries just below it.

3.5 The tour: autopilot and the ↻ button



1 `Auto Pilot Engaged` appears for about three seconds when the tour takes over. 2 The button reads `auto`.



1 After you take the controls the button reads `manual`. 2 The tour line says what brings the tour back.

- FlyingSalem **starts on the tour**. The autopilot flies between landmarks, and the tour line shows `toward: …` with the name of the next one.
- **Steering or touching the slider** takes the controls, and the button caption changes to `manual`.
- If you only steered, the tour **resumes by itself** about 25 seconds after you stop touching the screen.
- If you set a speed with the slider, the tour waits for you. **Tap ↻** (the circular-arrow button) to hand the aeroplane back to the tour at any time.

3.6 Pause and look around

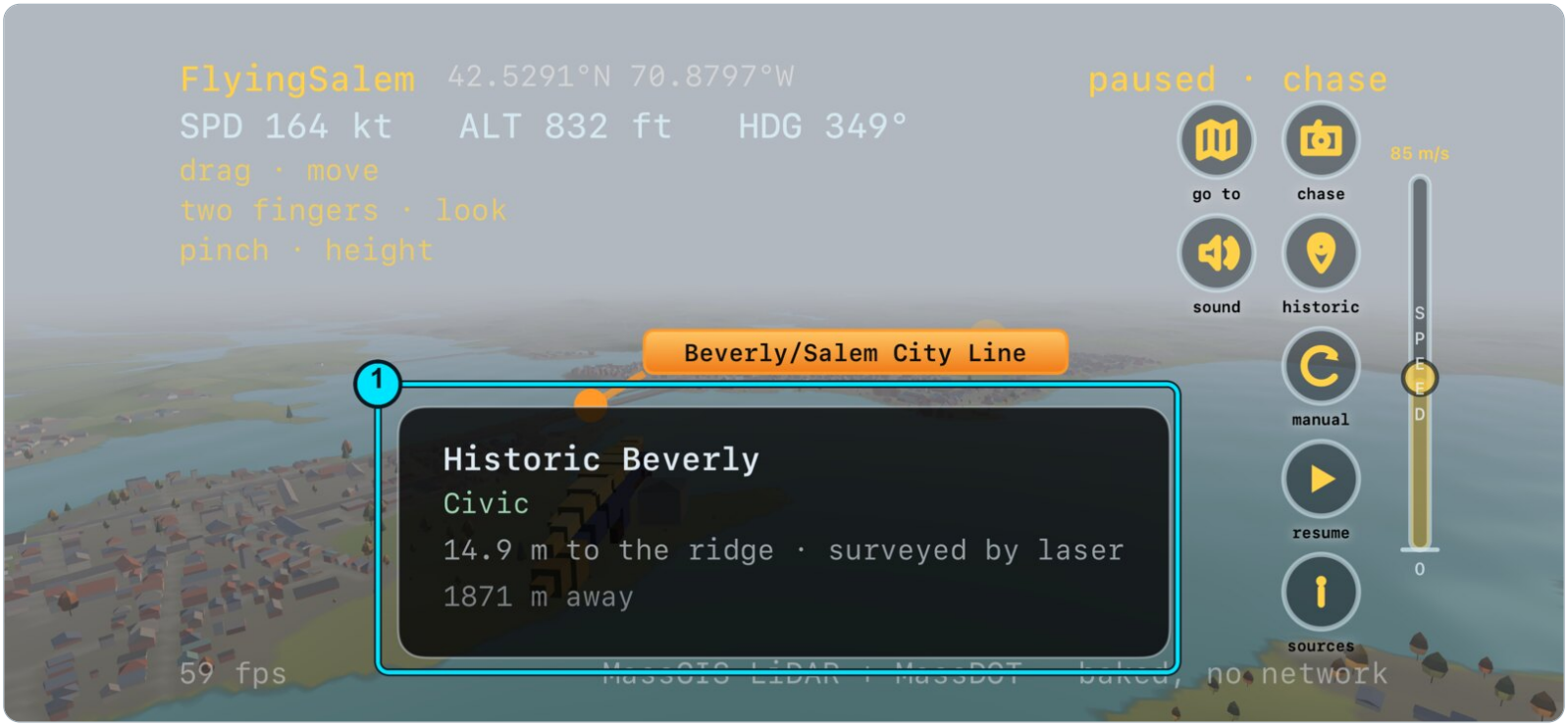


(1) While paused, the gestures are listed on screen. (2) The camera name reads `paused · chase`. (3) The pause button shows ▶ `resume`.

Gesture (while paused)	What it does
`drag · move`	One finger moves your viewpoint over the ground, the way you would drag a map. It covers more ground the higher you are.
`two fingers · look`	Drag with two fingers to turn left/right and tilt up/down.
`pinch · height`	Spread two fingers to rise, pinch them together to descend.

Tap ▶ **resume** to carry on flying. You can still tap places to ask about them while paused.

3.7 Ask about a place: tap a mark



1 The card for the place you tapped appears at the bottom of the screen.

Tap any orange mark or white dot with a **quick tap** and a card shows what is known about it:

- **Name.** In amber for a National Historic Landmark. Where a record has no name, its street address is shown instead.
- **Street address**, where the record has one.
- **Historic designation** (for example National Register), or the guide **category** (for example Civic).
- **Height**: `… m to the ridge · surveyed by laser`, measured from the survey where there is a building at that spot. If the survey found no building, this line is left out rather than guessed.
- **Distance** from you: `… m away`.

Tap empty ground to close the card. A tap picks the nearest mark within a fingertip of where you touched.

3.8 Sound: the speaker button



1 Muted: the speaker shows a cross and the caption reads `muted`.

As you fly, some places answer with sounds, such as lighthouses. Only notable places make a sound, so the town never becomes a wall of noise. There is no speech of any kind. Tap the speaker to switch between `sound` and `muted`. Sound stops while the app is in the background.

3.9 Jump anywhere: Go to

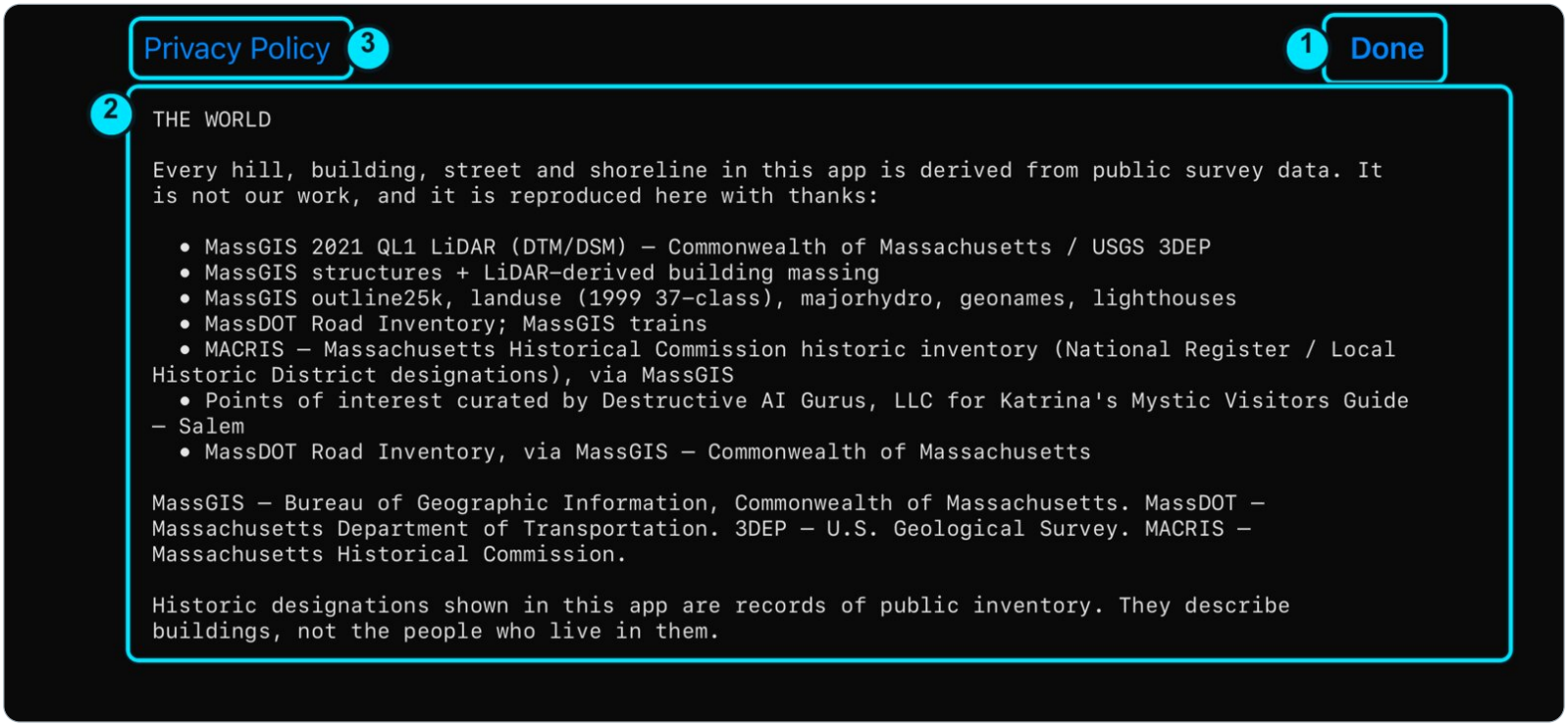


1 The map of Salem opens centred on your aeroplane (the blue arrow). 2 How to use it. 3 Zoom, width shown, how many places are marked, and how to close it.

On the map	What it does
Pinch	Zoom in and out (1× to 24×).
Drag	Pan around the map.
Tap a spot on the map	Fly there. The map closes and you continue from the new spot.
Tap outside the map	Close the map without moving.

The map shows the places of the layer you are on (historic, all, or none).

3.10 Sources: the (i) button



1 **Done** closes the sheet (you can also swipe it down). 2 The data sources. 3 **Privacy Policy** opens the privacy policy of Destructive AI Gurus, LLC in Safari. That page is on the web, so it needs an internet connection; nothing else in FlyingSalem does.

The world in FlyingSalem is built from public survey data, and this sheet credits it: MassGIS (including the 2021 LiDAR survey), MassDOT, the U.S. Geological Survey's 3DEP program, and the Massachusetts Historical Commission's historic inventory (MACRIS), plus the guide places curated by Destructive AI Gurus, LLC. Historic designations shown in the app are records of public inventory: they describe buildings, not the people who live in them.

Good to know

- **Landscape only.** Turn your device sideways.
- **No internet needed**, and nothing is downloaded. The whole town is inside the app.
- If a device runs short of memory or its graphics chip reports an error, the app lowers its drawing resolution automatically and keeps flying.
- If the app ever cannot start, it shows a short plain message instead of closing.
- **Age range.** Because some US states require it, the app may also ask Apple for your age range (Apple may ask you to share it). The answer stays on your iPhone or iPad, is used for nothing else, and is not kept.